provides to us involves many frustrations and obstacles along the way, but it still does not justify the choice to leak information to the media that will harm national security and undermine the foundations of the democratic system.

As for the Israeli officials mentioned, for whom it is impossible to claim that they were not exposed to all of the elements of the Iranian nuclear issue, their actions can be compared to those of the biblical prophets who stood, wrapped in cloaks, at the gates of the city and chastised the decision makers in the name of God. Jewish tradition asserts that there have not been any prophecies since the destruction of the Temple; the three men mentioned above did not claim that they were doing what they did in the name of God, but in my opinion they should have exhausted all means possible using the legitimate tools available to them. Left with no choice, they should have unanimously submitted their resignation to the prime minister and defense minister. The impact of that move would have caused a much greater earthquake than going to the media.

There is no doubt that a government should be prohibited from using the pretext of state security to cover up bureaucratic errors, political scandal, or illegal activity. However, it should be taken into account that it is difficult for courts to establish clear and unequivocal standards of the degree of potential or real harm resulting from the disclosure of information. Diplomatic developments and foreign relations are the result of innumerable components, forces, and events, making simple categorizations by the court impossible. The disclosure of critical information can generate a chain of events and developments that may only later turn out to have an effect on national security. One of the limitations of the method is that whether it is a demand to prevent publication, or a discussion, in retrospect, of information that has already been published, the political or security damage has already been done.

As a major force in our society, the press should be a loyal ally of the public. It must act responsibly in all matters relating to the publication of information that is liable to harm state security. Self-discipline and cooperation with the government can guarantee against revelations that can harm national security.

The resolution of the tension between national security and freedom of the press does not have to be a zero-sum game. In other words, it is not true that increased freedom of the press negatively affects national security, nor is